

Intelligence Briefing Project

Use standard 12pt font. No double spacing. Minimum of 2 pages for your brief!

Title, Introduction and Key Points:

Your Title, Introduction, and Key Points will usually be the last part of your brief that is written, because each of these components must summarize everything contained in the product.

The Executive Summary/Key Points and the Introduction, both of which should summarize all of the most important points in a brief, have very similar functions. Generally, Executive Summaries/Key Points are designed to be stand-alone documents of one or two pages that can convey the analytical impact of the full intelligence product (minus the details) to busy decisionmakers. An Introduction should briefly and generally sum up the main points of the paper.

Background:

The section that follows the Introduction should include background information that your audience will need in order to understand the results of your analysis. By presenting this information here, the next section can focus entirely on your analysis without getting bogged down with explanatory details and technical jargon. Because your product should focus primarily on the results of your analysis rather than the research you conducted to perform it, this section should be concise without sacrificing clarity. This section can be titled in any manner that is appropriate to its contents.

Bottom Line Up Front (BLUF):

In the BLUF format, the first sentence of each paragraph will sum up all of the information in the paragraph. A good BLUF should cover all of the information in a paragraph, like an umbrella. If the paragraph contains any information that doesn't fall under the BLUF's "umbrella," that information should be moved to a more appropriate paragraph or the BLUF should be changed to include the additional information. Following the BLUF, the component sentences in the paragraph should be arranged from most to least important.

Analysis:

The section that follows the Background section will contain your analysis, and will generally be the longest part of the paper. This section is often called "Substantiation" because it substantiates the assertions originally made in the Introduction. When communicating your analysis, it is imperative that you communicate in a way that is accurate, brief and clear. Writing clear and concise information forces analysts to carefully order their thoughts and think critically, and prevents accidental or intentional misrepresentation of the facts, thus improving the final analytical product. There is no place for the analyst's opinion or editorializing in intelligence analysis. Everything that you write must be based on facts that have been analyzed logically and, as much as possible, without biases. This section can be titled in any manner that is appropriate to its contents.

Accuracy, Brevity and Clarity:

In intelligence writing it's imperative that the language used is as clear, concise, and to-the-point as possible. Carefully chosen language that is accurate, brief, and clear leaves nothing to interpretation, and greatly reduces the likelihood that a decisionmaker will misinterpret your

analysis, and, as a result, make a decision that is contrary to U.S. interests. As a member of the intelligence community, national security and policies will be affected by, and the lives of servicemen and -women and civilians may depend on, your analysis and your ability to communicate it to decisionmakers in a way that is nothing less than crystal clear.

Outlook/Conclusion:

The Outlook, or conclusion, should neatly sum up the content of the paper. As such, the conclusion should never introduce new ideas. Rather, the Outlook expands upon ideas that have already been addressed in the Analysis section. It is the presentation of these ideas – not the ideas themselves – that is new. This section can be titled in any manner that is appropriate to its contents.

Citations:

Government publications rarely include detailed bibliographies or citations. However, for this class and project you are required to cite your sources. Use the format you are most comfortable with: MLA or APA.